INGLÉS · NIVEL A1 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Basic English sentence order A1: subject, verb, object, place and time

Build the sentence from the centre out: identify the subject, choose the verb frame, add the object or complement, and place location and time where the reader can process them naturally.

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Build clear A1 statements with an explicit subject and a controlled S-V-O / S-be-complement architecture.

MODELO

Nora studies English at home every evening. / Nora is tired after class.

Al terminar podrás

1. Build affirmative SVO clauses
2. Use be with a complement rather than an object
3. Place location and time naturally
4. Repair common Spanish-to-English order errors

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve las seis etapas y corrige al final. Vuelve al modelo para justificar cada decisión.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

01 · COMPRENDER

La idea esencial

English normally requires an explicit subject and a stable clause core. This lesson shows how subject, verb, object, complement, place and time fit together, why Spanish word order cannot be copied freely, and how to expand a short sentence without losing its structure.

Start with the clause core

The safest A1 sentence begins with a visible subject and a finite verb. English uses this core even when Spanish can omit the subject.

After the core, add only the object or complement that the verb allows. Study can take English; be takes a description or identity.

Frame	Use	Example
S + V	complete intransitive action	The class starts.
S + V + O	action on an object	Nora opens the book.
S + be + complement	identity or description	Nora is ready.

Separate lexical verbs from be

Be is already a complete finite verb: she is tired. Do not add do to an ordinary statement with be.

A lexical verb carries the action: she works here. Its negatives and questions use do or does, not a form of be.

Meaning	Correct	Avoid
state	She is tired.	She does tired.
action	She works here.	She is work here.
identity	He is a student.	He studies a student.

Build the object zone

A transitive verb needs or permits an object. The object normally follows the verb and does not move before it in a neutral statement.

Pronouns occupy the same object position: Nora calls Amir; Nora calls him. This creates a stable reference chain.

Subject	Verb	Object
Nora	reads	the message
We	need	a table
They	call	her

Place and time without a Spanish calque

At A1, place commonly comes before a broad time expression: I study at home every evening. This is a reliable neutral order.

A short time anchor can also open the sentence: On Monday, we study at home. The comma helps the reader recognise the frame.

Neutral end position	Fronted time
We meet at school on Monday.	On Monday, we meet at school.
She works in Bogotá every summer.	Every summer, she works in Bogotá.

Keep required subjects visible

English ordinary clauses need a grammatical subject. Weather and time use it; existence uses there.

These words do not translate a concrete object. They hold the subject position so the sentence has a complete English frame.

Function	Pattern	Example
weather	it + be	It is cold.
time	it + be	It is six o'clock.
existence	there + be	There are two cafés.

Expand in a controlled order

Add one layer at a time: Nora studies; Nora studies English; Nora studies English at home; Nora studies English at home every evening.

If the sentence becomes difficult, remove the optional layers and verify the core before rebuilding it.

Layer	Sentence
core	Nora studies.
object	Nora studies English.
place	Nora studies English at home.
time	Nora studies English at home every evening.

Read questions as a different architecture

A question changes the front of the clause but preserves the remaining order. Do you study English at home? keeps subject, verb and object after do.

With be, move be before the subject: Is Nora ready? Never add do to that frame.

Statement	Question
You study here.	Do you study here?
Nora is ready.	Is Nora ready?
They are at home.	Are they at home?

Use a final word-order audit

Check subject, finite verb, complement, place and time in that order. Then ask whether a question or negative requires an auxiliary.

The goal is not to force every sentence into one rigid line. It is to start from a dependable neutral frame and recognise the few controlled movements taught at A1.

Check	Question
subject	Who or what?
verb	What is finite?
complement	What does this verb require?
frame	Statement, negative or question?

From controlled form to real A1 communication

A learner controls Basic sentence order only when the form survives outside a single model sentence. Begin with the central contrast, rebuild it with a new subject and new vocabulary, and then place it inside a short exchange. The structure should remain accurate while the communicative details change.

Use a three-part review. First, name the intended meaning. Second, point to the word or position that carries that meaning. Third, read the whole sentence and check whether reference, agreement and register still fit the situation. This review turns a correct answer into a reusable A1 skill.

Do not judge the target form in isolation. Read the words immediately before and after it, identify the subject and the finite verb, and reconstruct the positive or neutral sentence when useful. This local context often explains an ending, an auxiliary, a determiner or a position that would otherwise seem arbitrary.

For independent study, complete one short stage at a time and record the reason for every correction. A useful note has three parts: the form you wrote, the form the sentence requires and the decision that separates them. Revisit that decision with a new example within twenty-four hours, then read both examples aloud and compare their rhythm with confidence.

Stage	Action	Success evidence
Recognise	identify the target decision	explains the meaning
Rebuild	change subject or vocabulary	keeps the pattern
Use	place it in a mini-dialogue	sounds complete
Review	correct and explain	names the controlling rule

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

subject -> verb -> object or complement -> place -> time

Decide en este orden

1. Find who or what the sentence is about.
2. Choose a lexical verb or a form of be.
3. Add only the complement licensed by that verb.
4. Place manner close to the action when needed.
5. Place location before the broad time expression.
6. Keep the subject visible in ordinary statements.
7. Move only the element required by a question pattern.
8. Read the complete sentence for meaning and rhythm.

Decision	Pattern	Example
Core SVO	studies	Nora studies English every day.
Third person	takes	Amir takes the bus at seven.
Be + adjective	is	The classroom is quiet.
Be + noun	is	Lina is a teacher.
Object	a film	We watch a film after dinner.
Place then time	at home on Fridays	They work at home on Fridays.
Required subject	It	It is cold today.
Existence	There are	There are two cafés near the station.
Manner	slowly	She speaks English slowly.

Errores frecuentes

× Is raining. -> It is raining.

× Likes Nora coffee. -> Nora likes coffee.

× Nora is study English. -> Nora studies English.

× I every day study at home. -> I study at home every day.

× She very likes music. -> She likes music very much.

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

Nora studies English every day.	The subject comes before the lexical verb.
Amir takes the bus at seven.	He/she/it takes -s in the present simple.
The classroom is quiet.	Be links the subject to an adjective complement.
Lina is a teacher.	A profession can be a complement after be.
We watch a film after dinner.	Watch licenses a direct object.
They work at home on Fridays.	A neutral A1 order is place before broad time.
It is cold today.	Weather clauses use the dummy subject it.
There are two cafés near the station.	There are presents plural existence.

De reconocer a producir

24 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

A · Recognise the pattern

1. Nora ___ English every day. Opciones: studies · study · is study · studies she

2. Amir ___ the bus at seven. Opciones: takes · take · is take · takes he

3. The classroom ___ quiet. Opciones: is · does · has · quiet is

4. Lina ___ a teacher. Opciones: is · does · teaches · a teacher is

5. We watch ___ after dinner. Opciones: a film · at home · every day · are film

6. They work ___. Opciones: at home on Fridays · on Fridays at home always · Fridays at home on · at Fridays home

7. ___ is cold today. Opciones: It · Is · There · The

8. ___ two cafés near the station. Opciones: There are · They are · Are · It has

9. She speaks English ___. Opciones: slowly · slow · at slowly · is slowly

10. I ___ check my email before class. Opciones: usually · check usually · am usually check · usual

11. He ___ coffee. Opciones: does not drink · not drinks · does not drinks · is not drink

12. ___ you work here? Opciones: Do · Are · Does · Is

B · Connect two decisions

13. Nora _____ English every day. Amir _____ the bus at seven. Opciones: studies · study · is study · studies she / takes · take · is take · takes he

14. The classroom _____ quiet. Lina _____ a teacher. Opciones: is · does · has · quiet is / is · does · teaches · a teacher is

15. We watch _____ after dinner. They work _____. Opciones: a film · at home · every day · are film / at home on Fridays · on Fridays at home always · Fridays at home on · at Fridays home

16. _____ is cold today. _____ two cafés near the station. Opciones: It · Is · There · The / There are · They are · Are · It has

17. She speaks English _____. I _____ check my email before class. Opciones: slowly · slow · at slowly · is slowly / usually · check usually · am usually check · usual

C · Read a connected text

18. Nora _____ English every day. Amir _____ the bus at seven. The classroom _____ quiet. Lina _____ a teacher. We watch _____ after dinner. They work _____. _____ is cold today. _____ two cafés near the station.

D · Retrieve without options

19. _____ is cold today. _____ two cafés near the station. She speaks English _____. I _____ check my email before class. He _____ coffee. _____ you work here?

E · Produce in context

20. Write three SVO sentences about Nora's morning, adding place and time.

_____

21. Write two sentences with be and two with lexical verbs about a classroom.

_____

22. Correct: "Every day studies Amir English at home." Explain the order.

_____

F · Final mission

23. Write 80-110 words describing one weekday. Use six explicit subjects, three lexical verbs, two be clauses, one object pronoun, place and time expressions, one negative and one question.

_____

24. Choose two sentences from your mission. For each one, name the Basic sentence order decision and explain why the selected form fits.

_____

04 · SOLUCIONES

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. studies — The subject comes before the lexical verb.
2. takes — He/she/it takes -s in the present simple.
3. is — Be links the subject to an adjective complement.
4. is — A profession can be a complement after be.
5. a film — Watch licenses a direct object.
6. at home on Fridays — A neutral A1 order is place before broad time.
7. It — Weather clauses use the dummy subject it.
8. There are — There are presents plural existence.
9. slowly — A manner adverb describes the action.
10. usually — Frequency normally precedes a lexical verb.
11. does not drink — Does carries agreement; drink stays in the base form.
12. Do — A lexical verb in the present simple uses do.
13. studies / takes — The subject comes before the lexical verb. He/she/it takes -s in the present simple.
14. is / is — Be links the subject to an adjective complement. A profession can be a complement after be.
15. a film / at home on Fridays — Watch licenses a direct object. A neutral A1 order is place before broad time.
16. It / There are — Weather clauses use the dummy subject it. There are presents plural existence.
17. slowly / usually — A manner adverb describes the action. Frequency normally precedes a lexical verb.
18. studies / takes / is / is / a film / at home on Fridays / It / There are — The subject comes before the lexical verb. He/she/it takes -s in the present simple. Be links the subject to an adjective complement. A profession can be a complement after be. Watch licenses a direct object. A neutral A1 order is place before broad time. Weather clauses use the dummy subject it. There are presents plural existence.
19. It / There are / slowly / usually / does not drink / Do — Weather clauses use the dummy subject it. There are presents plural existence. A manner adverb describes the action. Frequency normally precedes a lexical verb. Does carries agreement; drink stays in the base form. A lexical verb in the present simple uses do.
20. Nora drinks coffee in the kitchen at seven. She checks her messages at home before work. She takes the bus to school every morning. — Each clause keeps a visible subject and a stable core.
21. The classroom is bright. The students are ready. They open their books. The teacher explains the task slowly. — The two clause frames remain distinct.
22. Amir studies English at home every day. Subject, verb and object form the core; place precedes the broad time expression. — The correction restores the neutral A1 order.
23. On weekdays, I get up at six thirty. My sister is usually awake too, but my parents are still asleep. I make breakfast in the kitchen and eat it near the window. Then I check my bag because I do not want to forget my notebook. At seven thirty, we take the bus to school. Is the bus always on time? No, it is sometimes late. My first class starts at eight, and our teacher explains the plan clearly. After class, I study English in the library for thirty minutes. — The text maintains complete subjects and controlled clause order across different frames.
24. Nora studies English every day. The subject comes before the lexical verb. Amir takes the bus at seven. He/she/it takes -s in the present simple. — The audit makes the learner connect a produced form with its controlling decision.

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.

Retrieval

Review focus	Retrieval	Feedback
Build affirmative SVO clauses	Explain and exemplify: Build affirmative SVO clauses.	Find who or what the sentence is about.
Use be with a complement rather than an object	Explain and exemplify: Use be with a complement rather than an object.	Choose a lexical verb or a form of be.

Review focus	Retrieval	Feedback
Place location and time naturally	Explain and exemplify: Place location and time naturally.	Add only the complement licensed by that verb.
Repair common Spanish-to-English order errors	Explain and exemplify: Repair common Spanish-to-English order errors.	Place manner close to the action when needed.